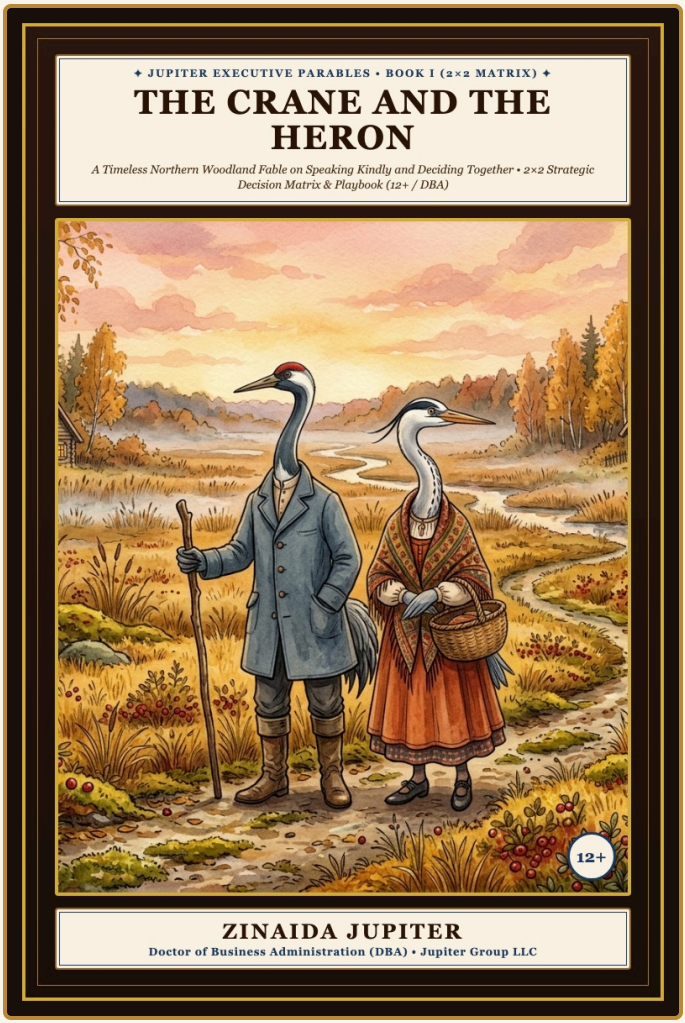
EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



THE CRANE AND THE HERON

A Timeless Northern Woodland Fable on Speaking Kindly and Deciding Together

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group"

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Jupiter, Zinaida Sergeevna (DBA). *THE CRANE AND THE HERON: Executive & Strategic 2×2 Decision Matrix Edition (Ages 12+).* — Book I of XVI in the *Jupiter Wisdom Tales* Series.
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Exclusive Worldwide Publisher & Rights Holder: Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group" (OsOO "Jupiter Group" / Imprint: Jupiter Group Publishing), State Reg. No. 217940-3310-OOO, TIN (INN) 01705202310085, OKPO 31950675, 4 A. Borubaeva St., Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic (Managing Director: Vladimir Yuryevich Jupiter), under Exclusive Worldwide Publishing Agreement No. **JG-PUB-2023-0517**.
Languages: Published originally in English for global distribution, with official translations into Russian and Mandarin Chinese.
ISBN-13: 978-9967-00-012-5 • **Official Storefronts:** https://jupitergroop.github.io/jupiter-wisdom-tales/ & https://jupiter-wisdom-tales.com

Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *THE CRANE AND THE HERON* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Echoes Aesop's classic fables of pride and timing, the Eastern parable of 'The Traveller of Yan', and the Panchatantra tale of two proud travellers at the river crossing.

> **Proverb of the Book:** *"Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. SEVEN MILES OF MOSSY MARSH BETWEEN TWO LONELY NEIGHBOURS ❧



Across the misty northern marshland stood two cosy cottages, seven miles apart. In one lived the stately Crane; in the other lived the graceful Heron. Growing weary of the quiet evenings alone by his hearth, the Crane decided to walk across the marsh and invite his neighbour to build a warm home together.

Putting on his finest embroidered coat and taking his carved walking staff, the Crane stepped out into the morning dew. Though the mossy path was soft and tangled, his heart was light with the hope of companionship.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth."*

❧ SHEET II. THE FIRST KNOCK AND THE COLD WALL OF PRIDE ❧



When the Crane reached the Heron's cottage and bowed politely at her window, he spoke with an open heart: 'Dear neighbour, let us unite our two homes into one! Together winter will be warm and joyful.'

Yet the Heron tilted her beak high, afraid to seem too eager, and answered with a chilly wave of her wing: 'No indeed, Crane! Your legs are too long, your coat is too short, and you fly far too clumsily. Go back to your own side of the marsh!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth."*

❧ SHEET III. THE QUIET SAMOVAR AND THE REGRET OF A PROUD HEART ❧



Wounded to the core, the Crane bowed silently and trudged seven miles home through the mire. Meanwhile, as evening shadows lengthened across the reeds, the Heron sat alone beside her cooling samovar.

Listening to the autumn wind, she realized her mistake: 'Why did I turn away such a kind and steady neighbour? Pride warms a room for five minutes, and then leaves it cold. I shall walk to his cottage myself and say yes!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *“Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth.”*

❧ SHEET IV. THE PENDULUM SWINGS: RETALIATION INSTEAD OF WELCOME ❧



Wrapping her patterned shawl around her shoulders, the Heron walked the seven marshy miles and knocked softly at the Crane's door: 'Dear Crane, forgive my foolish pride! I have thought it over—let us build our home together.'

Now the Crane's wish had come true on his own doorstep! Yet wounded vanity flared inside him, and he turned toward the window: 'No, Heron! I no longer wish to marry at all. Return to your own cottage!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth."*

❧ SHEET V. BREAKING THE ENDLESS PATH WITH A GOLDEN BRIDGE ❧



No sooner had the garden gate clicked behind the weeping Heron than the Crane grasped his head: 'What have I done? I wanted her friendship all along, yet I traded happiness for a moment of sweet revenge!'

In the old fable, they walk back and forth forever along that muddy trail. Yet wise families and leaders know the secret that breaks the spell: meet in the middle of the bridge today, accept the first honest step toward peace, and put the warm samovar on the table together!

> ***Key Insight:*** *“Pride wears out seven pairs of boots in the marsh, while one kind word lights the hearth.”*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did the Heron say 'no' the first time?**
  Did she truly dislike the Crane, or did she want to seem proud and important without thinking how her sharp words would hurt a friend?
- **2. Why did the Crane turn her away when she came to apologize?**
  When someone admits their mistake and walks seven miles to make peace, why is saying 'Now I don't want to!' a trap for both sides?
- **3. How can we build a 'Golden Bridge' at home?**
  What warm phrase can we say within five minutes of a misunderstanding so nobody has to march back and forth across the marsh?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *Your friend or sibling accidentally spoke sharply during a game, and ten minutes later comes to your room offering half of their favourite apple to make peace.*

Path 1 (The Heron's Pride): Turn your nose up and say: 'Your apple is too small, and I don't play with you anymore!'

Path 2 (The Crane's Revenge): Wait until they ask three more times just to make them feel as sad as you felt earlier.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (The Golden Bridge!): Smile, take the apple slice right away, and say: 'Thank you for coming! Let's finish building our castle together.'

❖ **Creative Task: Draw the wooden Golden Bridge across the marsh with a warm lantern in the middle where the Crane and the Heron finally meet and shake wings!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Tonight at dinner, agree on the rule 'One Clear Request Instead of Three Hints': if someone wants help or warmth, they ask kindly with a smile.

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: DESIRE FOR FAMILY HARMONY → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: WARMTH & RESPECT FOR LOVED ONES

Lesson II • Keeping Score & Revenge
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
A loved one comes to make peace, but we push them away just to 'even the score.'

★ GOLDEN BRIDGE OF HARMONY
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
We value our family above momentary pride: we accept peace on the first knock and share warm tea.

Lesson I • Cold Refusal at the Door
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Meeting a kind offer with mockery or picky complaints ('legs too long, coat too short').

Lesson III • Silent Waiting Around the Table
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Nobody argues aloud, yet everyone waits stubbornly for the other person to speak first.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Speak from the heart without prickly words: If you want to play or need help, ask warmly instead of testing the other person with riddles.

2. Welcome peace on the very first knock: When a loved one comes to apologize, open the door wide without keeping score.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. The Crane on Visit One — Unprepared Initiator:** Enters a high-stakes negotiation with good intentions but without pre-framing the partner's value or timing.
- **2. The Heron on Visit One — Positional Arrogance:** Rejects a mutually beneficial alliance out of status posturing ('legs too long'), mistaking rudeness for leverage.
- **3. The Crane on Visit Two — The Ego-Revenge Trap:** Sacrifices a profitable, strategic deal just to enjoy ten seconds of emotional payback against a returning partner.
- **4. The Muddy Marsh Trail — Transaction Cost of Delay:** Every extra round of 'walking back and forth' burns executive time, working capital, and market window.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Confusing Ego Retaliation with Negotiation Strength: When a counterparty reconsiders and returns to the table, punishing them with a cold rejection destroys your own P&L.

Trap 2 — Open-Ended Negotiation Without a Decision Clock: Allowing deals to oscillate for months without a clear 'Golden Bridge' term sheet and expiration date.

★ TheQuadrant 4 Solution — Harvard 'Golden Bridge' Protocol: Separate wounded vanity from economic value: make it easy for the partner to say 'Yes' while locking in clear terms within 48 hours.

AXIS Y ↑: MUTUAL ECONOMIC VALUE & RESPECT → | AXIS X ►: DECISION SPEED & CLARITY OF TERMS (EGO PENDULUM & DELAY → CLEAR 48H DECISION BRIDGE)

Quadrant 2 • Emotional Payback
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
High mutual value exists, yet the deal collapses because leaders trade barbs over past slights.

★ THE GOLDEN ALLIANCE BRIDGE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
High mutual respect combined with a crisp decision window and zero ego friction.

Quadrant 1 • The Marsh of Pride
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Endless back-and-forth emails, wounded vanity, and total loss of the market window.

Quadrant 3 • Polite Stagnation
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Friendly meetings without commitment, deadlines, or signed heads of terms.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Are we walking the marsh trail again?"	Our teams are trading prideful emails instead of closing a deal both sides need.	**★ Schedule a 15-minute principal-to-principal call and sign the term sheet today.**
"Don't play Crane on the second visit"	A key client or partner has returned ready to agree—do not let past ego ruin the close.	**★ Welcome the partner warmly and lock in the Quadrant 4 contract.**
"Build the Heron a Golden Bridge"	Give the counterparty a face-saving way to step back from an earlier refusal.	**★ Frame the revised offer as a joint win with updated scope.**
"Seven miles of marsh cost"	The hidden cost of delay is exceeding the value of the concession we are arguing over.	**★ Set a 48-hour Long-Stop Date: close or reallocate capital.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
UNIDROIT Principles Art. 2.1.15 (Good Faith in Negotiations); English Law Heads of Terms with Long-Stop Date & Symmetric Buy-Sell Deadlock Resolution.

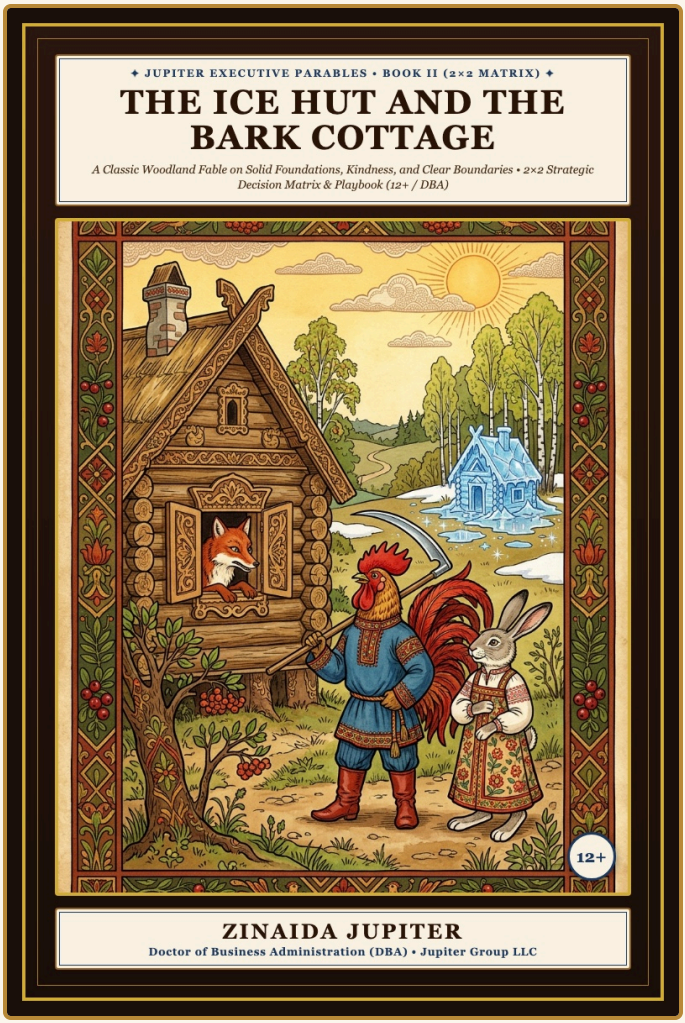
JUPITER WISDOM TALES • INTERNATIONAL COLLECTOR IMPRINT

THE CRANE AND THE HERON (Book I of XVI)

Author & Series Creator: Zinaida Sergeevna Jupiter, DBA
Exclusive Worldwide Publisher: Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group" (OsOO "Jupiter Group")
Publishing License: Exclusive Worldwide Publishing Agreement No. JG-PUB-2023-0517
State Registration No.: 217940-3310-OOO • **TIN (INN):** 01705202310085 • **OKPO:** 31950675
Registering Authority: Osh Justice Department, Ministry of Justice of the Kyrgyz Republic
Registered Legal Address: 4 A. Borubaeva Street, Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic
Managing Director (CEO): Vladimir Yuryevich Jupiter
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Verified by Ministry of Justice KR:
https://record.minjust.gov.kg/view/01705202310085

EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



THE ICE HUT AND THE BARK COTTAGE

A Classic Woodland Fable on Solid Foundations, Kindness, and Clear Boundaries

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group"

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Jupiter, Zinaida Sergeevna (DBA). *THE ICE HUT AND THE BARK COTTAGE: Executive & Strategic 2×2 Decision Matrix Edition (Ages 12+).* — Book II of XVI in the *Jupiter Wisdom Tales* Series.
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ISBN-13: 978-9967-00-022-8 • **Official Storefronts:** https://jupitergroop.github.io/jupiter-wisdom-tales/ & https://jupiter-wisdom-tales.com

Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *THE ICE HUT AND THE BARK COTTAGE* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Parallels the classic Eastern proverb of 'The Camel's Nose in the Tent' and the Panchatantra tale of the Sparrow and the Hare resolved by clear rule of law.

> **Proverb of the Book:** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. TWO COTTAGES AT THE EDGE OF THE WINTER FOREST ❧



At the edge of a sparkling birch forest lived the Fox and the Hare. As autumn leaves fell, the boastful Fox fashioned a glittering palace of river ice, while the patient Hare worked from dawn till dusk building a sturdy cottage of seasoned timber and warm linden bark.

All winter long the Fox teased her neighbour: 'Look how my crystal walls shine in the sun, while your bark roof looks plain and humble!' The Hare only smiled and stacked dry birch logs beside his brick stove.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

❧ SHEET II. SPRING SUN AND THE CREEPING REQUEST ('JUST ONTO THE PORCH!') ❧



When April sunshine warmed the woods, the Hare's timber cottage stood dry and fragrant, while the Fox's icy palace melted into a puddle on the grass.

Shivering, the Fox knocked at the Hare's window: 'Dear Hare, let me warm my paws just on your porch!' The kind Hare opened the door—and by evening the Fox had climbed onto the warm stove and chased the rightful owner out into the cold.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

❧ SHEET III. LOUD TITLES THAT RETREAT AT THE FIRST GROWL ❧



Weeping beside the forest path, the little Hare met the Grey Wolf and then the great Brown Bear. Both promised loudly: 'Stop crying, little Hare! With our mighty fangs and roaring voices, we will drive that Fox out in a heartbeat!'

Yet the moment the Fox shouted fiercely from the warm stove, both the Wolf and the Bear trembled, made excuses, and hurried back into the woods. Status without persistence could not reclaim the home.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

❧ SHEET IV. THE GOLDEN ROOSTER AND THE TRUMPET OF TRUTH ❧



Along came the brisk Golden Rooster wearing tall red boots and carrying a shining brass Trumpet of Truth and the Charter of the Forest Council: 'Dry your tears, brother Hare! Right is on your side—let us march to your cottage together!'

Ignoring the Fox's bluster, the Rooster stepped firmly onto the porch, sounded his clear golden trumpet, and proclaimed twice that unlawful seizure would face the entire forest assembly before noon.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

❧ SHEET V. JUSTICE RESTORED AND THE CHARTER ON THE OAK DOOR ❧



Hearing the unwavering voice of law and seeing the whole woodland gathering behind the Rooster, the Fox lost all her bravado, leaped out the window, and fled into the distant hills.

The Hare welcomed the brave Rooster to a steaming samovar, and on his oak door he carved the golden rule of hospitality: 'A kind heart opens the door to guests, but clear rules protect the hearth!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A warm heart welcomes a guest to the table, while clear boundaries keep the home safe."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did the Fox's glittering house melt while the Hare's cottage stood firm?**
  What is the difference between doing something just to show off quickly and building something with patience and care?
- **2. How did the Fox take over the cottage step by step?**
  She asked first for the porch, then the bench, then the stove. Why is it kind to share, yet wise to state clear rules from the start?
- **3. Why did the small Rooster succeed where the big Bear failed?**
  What matters more when defending fairness—a loud boast from afar, or calm, determined courage that goes all the way?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *A classmate asks to borrow your favourite coloured pencils 'just for one minute,' and then keeps your whole pencil case on their desk and refuses to give it back.*

Path 1 (Silent Tears in the Corner): Cry quietly and give up your pencils because you are afraid to speak up.

Path 2 (Loud Shouting & Pushing): Start a noisy fight that gets both of you in trouble without solving the rule.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (The Rooster's Clear Voice!):
Speak calmly, firmly, and openly—and if needed, invite the teacher or fair mediator: 'I gladly shared for one drawing, and now it is time to return my case to my desk.'

❖ **Creative Task: Draw the Hare's cosy wooden bark cottage with the brave Golden Rooster and the House Charter of Friendship on the oak door!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Discuss 'Kindness with Clear Rules': sharing toys is wonderful when everyone agrees upfront on how and when things return home.

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: KINDNESS & WARMTH OF HEART → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: CLEAR BOUNDARIES & COURAGE

Lesson II • Naive Surrender of the Home
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Being so afraid to say 'no' to pushy guests that you lose your own peace and room.

★ WARM HEARTH WITH STRONG WALLS
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
A generous, welcoming home where clear rules and brave mutual support protect everyone.

Lesson I • The Melting Ice Palace
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Boasting without effort and then trying to solve problems at someone else's expense.

Lesson III • Locked Fortress Without Friends
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Keeping the door bolted out of fear and never sharing tea or joy with neighbours.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Build on solid bark, not melting ice: In schoolwork, craft, and promises, choose lasting quality over flashy shortcuts.

2. Kindness and firm boundaries walk together: Sharing with friends is wonderful when everyone respects the owner and the rules of the home.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. The Hare — Creator of Tangible Core Assets ('Bark Cottage'):** Builds real technology, loyal clients, and cash flow, yet initially lacks legal perimeter security.
- **2. The Fox — Opportunistic Raider ('Creeping Scope'):** Uses crisis empathy ('just onto the porch') to gain access to client databases, IP, or equity without capital investment.
- **3. Wolf & Bear — High-Fee Status Advisors Without Teeth:** Prestigious consultants who promise quick victories in slides but retreat at the first real courtroom or market pushback.
- **4. The Golden Rooster — Precision Legal & Operational Enforcer:** Focused specialist armed with clear documentation, injunctive leverage, and readiness to execute to the end.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Granting 'Porch Access' Before Signing NDA & Revocation Clauses: Letting a distributor, co-founder, or contractor into core infrastructure on a verbal handshake.

Trap 2 — Hiring 'Bears' by Title Instead of 'Roosters' by Track Record: Paying for big-name advisory retainers instead of enforceable legal and technical kill-switches.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Ironclad Property Rights & Open Hospitality: Welcome partners generously into the guest room while keeping the 'stove' (IP, cap table, root keys) under strict legal lock.

AXIS Y ↑: OPENNESS TO PARTNERSHIPS & GROWTH → | AXIS X ►: LEGAL & TECHNICAL ASSET PROTECTION (VERBAL TRUST ('ONTO THE PORCH') → HARD CONTRACTS & KILL-SWITCH)

Quadrant 2 • Hostile Takeover Risk
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Strong product and open heart, but zero legal perimeter—inviting creeping expropriation.

★ PROTECTED BARK FORTRESS
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
High partnership synergy backed by prior NDA, IP registration, and instant enforcement.

Quadrant 1 • Melting Ice Venture
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
PR hype without real product fundamentals or legal durability—collapses in the first spring.

Quadrant 3 • Paralyzed Bunker
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Total legal paranoia that blocks every partnership, pilot, and market expansion.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Is this a Bark Cottage or an Ice Palace?"	Does this project have real unit economics, or will it melt at the first market shift?	**★ Audit cash flow and structural durability before allocating CAPEX.**
"No Foxes on the porch without a contract"	A partner is asking for early access to our code/clients before signing terms.	**★ Block root access until NDA, non-compete, and revocation clauses are signed.**
"Stop calling the Bear—bring in the Rooster"	Status meetings are not resolving a contract breach.	**★ Engage a specialized litigator or execute the contractual step-in / kill-switch right.**
"Keep the stove in the founder's name"	Never transfer core IP, domains, or trademark control to a temporary operational partner.	**★ Ring-fence core IP in the holding entity.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
International Property & IP Ring-Fencing; Strict SaaS/API Revocation & Kill-Switch Clauses; Expedited UNCITRAL Arbitration.

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Publishing License: Exclusive Worldwide Publishing Agreement No. JG-PUB-2023-0517
State Registration No.: 217940-3310-OOO • **TIN (INN):** 01705202310085 • **OKPO:** 31950675
Registering Authority: Osh Justice Department, Ministry of Justice of the Kyrgyz Republic
Registered Legal Address: 4 A. Borubaeva Street, Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic
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Verified by Ministry of Justice KR:
https://record.minjust.gov.kg/view/01705202310085

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TOPS AND BOTTOMS

A Classic Harvest Fable on Knowledge, Honest Work, and Fair Agreements

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Cross-Cultural Bridge: Connects with the European folk tale 'The Peasant and the Devil' (Brothers Grimm) and classic Asian agricultural parables on domain competence.

> **Proverb of the Book:** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. THE SPRING CLEARING AND THE BEAR'S BARGAIN ❧



Early one spring a hardworking Farmer rode out to a sunny forest clearing to plough the soil and plant sweet golden turnips. No sooner had he cut the first furrow than the great Brown Bear stepped out of the oak woods and roared: 'Farmer! Why are you ploughing in my forest? I shall crush your cart!'

Taking off his cap calmly, the clever Farmer replied: 'Do not be angry, Master Bear! Let us farm this field as partners: I shall plough, sow, and tend the crop all summer, and in autumn we shall divide the harvest fairly. Tell me now—who takes the Tops, and who takes the Bottoms?' Thinking that whatever grows above ground in the sun must be finest, the Bear boomed: 'The Tops for me, and the Bottoms for you!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET II. AUTUMN TURNIPS: LUSH LEAVES VS. SWEET ROOTS ❧



All summer long the Farmer weeded and watered the field while the Bear napped in the shade. By autumn the turnips had grown round, heavy, and sweet as amber beneath the soil.

When the Bear arrived to claim his share, the Farmer honestly cut every green leaf and piled a mountain of turnip tops onto the Bear's cart, while loading the firm golden turnip roots onto his own wagon.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET III. A BITE OF BITTER GREENS ON THE FOREST STUMP ❧



Sitting on a mossy stump, the Bear chewed his green tops—and frowned, for turnip leaves are tough and bitter! Just then the Farmer rode past eating a fragrant steamed turnip.

Tasting one sweet slice, the Bear roared: 'Your bottoms are sweet as honey, while my tops are bitter! Next spring when you plant this clearing, you shall give me the Bottoms and keep the Tops for yourself!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *“He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life.”*

❧ SHEET IV. SEASON TWO: GOLDEN WHEAT UNDER THE SUMMER SUN ❧



The following spring the Farmer returned to the same clearing—but this time he sowed golden wheat instead of turnips. By August the field stood like a rustling sea of heavy amber ears.

Out marched the Bear, pointing his paw at the ground: 'Remember our new contract, Farmer! Last year I lost on the tops—this time give me every Bottom in the earth, and take the Tops for yourself!' The Farmer bowed: 'As you command, Master Bear!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET V. FULL SHEAVES OF GRAIN AND THE WISDOM OF FAIR SHARING ❧



Together they reaped the field: the Farmer gathered the rich, grain-filled wheat ears—the Tops—and baked warm white loaves for his family, while the Bear was left with dry, prickly wheat roots in the dirt.

From this classic harvest tale, wise families and partners learn a double truth: first, always understand the nature of the work before signing a deal; second, the strongest partnership lasts for years when both sides share both the labour and the sweet harvest fairly!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did the Bear choose the wrong half twice in a row?**
  Did he take the time to learn how turnips and wheat grow, or did he just shout loudly and demand the biggest-looking pile?
- **2. Why is real knowledge stronger than a loud roar?**
  How did the Farmer's knowledge of plants and daily work help him stay calm in front of the huge Bear?
- **3. How do true friends share a harvest?**
  If the Bear had helped water the field and asked to share the real fruit fairly, how could both neighbours have feasted together?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *You and your sibling or classmate are making a poster for school. One of you wants to do none of the drawing or reading, but demands to take the whole prize home.*

Path 1 (The Bear's Loud Demand): Shout 'I get the best part!' without helping or understanding the task.

Path 2 (Sly Trickery Between Friends): Trick your friend with a confusing rule so they get nothing and never trust you again.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (Honest Work & Fair Halves!): Divide both the work and the reward fairly from the start so both partners are proud and happy!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw what grows underground (sweet turnips and carrots—Bottoms!) and what ripens in the sun (golden wheat ears—Tops!)!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Show your child a carrot and a tomato tonight: ask which grows underground and which ripens in the sun—celebrating curiosity and real knowledge!

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: KNOWLEDGE OF THE CRAFT & DILIGENCE → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: HONESTY & FAIR SHARING IN THE FAMILY

Lesson II • Clever Defense Alone
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
The Farmer saves his harvest with wit, yet without fair cooperation no lasting friendship forms.

★ UNION OF KNOWLEDGE, WORK & FAIRNESS
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
Deep understanding of the task combined with shared effort and fair division of the fruit.

Lesson I • The Bear's Lazy Roar
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Demanding the best share loudly while refusing both to work and to learn how things grow.

Lesson III • Blindly Repeating Yesterday's Rule
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Trying to follow rules while copying yesterday's answer when the crop has already changed.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Learn how the world works from root to crown: Curiosity, reading, and craft protect you from foolish mistakes.

2. Share both the effort and the joy: In a loving family and team, whoever helps plant and tend the garden shares the sweetest fruit.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. The Farmer — Domain Expert & Operational Architect:** Possesses deep technical know-how and executes 100% of the fieldwork, using information asymmetry to survive a coercive partner.
- **2. The Bear — Capital/Power Holder With Zero Domain Due Diligence:** Uses positional dominance ('my forest') to dictate contract terms without understanding where EBITDA is actually generated.
- **3. Season One ('Turnips') — The Gross Revenue Illusion:** Taking flashy top-line turnover ('green tops') while the operational partner retains net cash flow and IP ('sweet roots').
- **4. Season Two ('Wheat') — Mechanical Extrapolation of Past Rules:** Blindly copying last year's contract clause into a new market model and losing the entire harvest a second time.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Dictating Contract Terms Without Understanding the Value Chain: Demanding 'Tops' or 'Bottoms' by force when you have not audited whether the asset is a root crop or grain.

Trap 2 — Winning Round One by Clever Wording and Losing the Venture in Round Two: If a contract relies on a hidden catch, the counterparty will exit in rage—destroying long-term compounding.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Transparent Value-Chain SLA & Joint Venture Alignment: Define the exact economic metric (Net Distributable Profit / IP) and align rewards with each partner's real contribution.

AXIS Y ↑: DOMAIN MASTERY & VALUE-CHAIN CLARITY → | AXIS X ►: FAIRNESS & TRANSPARENCY OF CONTRACT (ONE-SIDED COERCION OR TRICK → FAIR WIN-WIN EQUITY SPLIT)

Quadrant 2 • Tactical Outsmarting
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
You win one harvest through contract wording, but turn your partner into a permanent enemy.

★ SUSTAINABLE JOINT VENTURE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
Full transparency on where value ripens + fair profit-sharing tied to real contribution.

Quadrant 1 • The Bear's Blindness
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Bullying negotiations without domain knowledge—ending up with bitter leaves and dry roots.

Quadrant 3 • Naive Good Intentions
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Friendly handshake without auditing unit economics—both sides harvest weeds.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Are we buying Tops or Bottoms here?"	Do we understand where the real net margin and IP live in this deal, or are we looking at vanity foliage?	**★ Run a unit-economics audit before signing.**
"Don't fight the last season's turnip war"	We are applying an old rule to a completely new business model ('wheat instead of turnips').	**★ Re-verify assumptions for the current market cycle.**
"A one-season trick kills a ten-year partnership"	Clever fine print that hurts our partner today will cost us the alliance tomorrow.	**★ Rewrite the clause so both sides win on the core metric.**
"Share the grain, not the chaff"	Tie executive and partner incentives to verified net value created.	**★ Align KPIs with net cash flow and customer retention.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
Joint Venture Specification Schedule; Deliverable Definition by Measurable Output; Pre-Investment Technical Due Diligence.

JUPITER WISDOM TALES • INTERNATIONAL COLLECTOR IMPRINT

TOPS AND BOTTOMS (Book III of XVI)

Author & Series Creator: Zinaida Sergeevna Jupiter, DBA
Exclusive Worldwide Publisher: Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group" (OsOO "Jupiter Group")
Publishing License: Exclusive Worldwide Publishing Agreement No. JG-PUB-2023-0517
State Registration No.: 217940-3310-OOO • **TIN (INN):** 01705202310085 • **OKPO:** 31950675
Registering Authority: Osh Justice Department, Ministry of Justice of the Kyrgyz Republic
Registered Legal Address: 4 A. Borubaeva Street, Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic
Managing Director (CEO): Vladimir Yuryevich Jupiter
Languages: Published originally in English; officially translated into Russian and Mandarin Chinese.
Official Storefronts: https://jupitergroop.github.io/jupiter-wisdom-tales/ • https://jupiter-wisdom-tales.com

Verified by Ministry of Justice KR:
https://record.minjust.gov.kg/view/01705202310085